In the morning he would open the door and rush to insert the key

and turn off the alarm, and in the interim, r-ring-g-g it would go at 6:00 a.m. No one ever complained as far as I know, but since I have always been a light sleeper anyway, I never missed them.

It was the first ripoff we had ever suffered, and my father didn't stop talking about it for months. No matter how well things went in the store 4 and how favorable the balance was, he would say, "If we still had that four hundred dollars . . ."

One of our customers walked in as the burglar alarm was being installed and said, "Aren't you locking the barn door after the horse has been stolen?" (The purpose of aphorisms is to keep fools who have memorized them from having nothing to say.)

"We've bought another horse," I said, taking the chance that my father would scold me for talking back to a customer.

Aunt Pauline and Cousin Martin were over that afternoon to commiserate. There was still a tenuous connection between the two branches of the family. Indeed, Cousin Martin dropped in periodically over the next few years, but my best memory of him is of that afternoon. We sat in the living room and talked Shakespeare— Hamlet, specifically. As I recall, I was made very uneasy by the fact that he seemed more familiar with the play than I was.

4 They went pretty well at that. At least there was no need for me to get a summer job in 1937 or in 1938. My NYA job was enough and the store could handle the rest of the tuition and miscellaneous expenses in my junior and senior years.

Astounding Science Fiction

In the spring of 1938, Astounding Stories gained a new editor: F. Orlin Tremaine was out, and in his place was John Wood Campbell, Jr., who was then not quite twenty-eight, and who, through the early and mid-1930s, had made a name for himself as one of the greatest science-fiction writers of the period. Certainly he was one of my favorites.

Campbell instantly began to remold the magazine closer to his (and, inadvertently, my) heart's desire. For one thing, he changed the title to Astounding Science Fiction, which, to me, was a promising sign of further